

You'll be advised on how to prepare yourself for the birth, what to expect in the first few days postpartum, and how to encourage healing afterward. You will also be given information on caring for a newborn, including diaper changing, bathing, and establishing breastfeeding.

FIRST-TIME LABOR

In your first pregnancy, the [cervix dilates](#) by about 0.5 cm every hour, compared to 1.5 cm an hour for subsequent babies. You will probably push, on average, for more than one hour with your first baby. With your second baby, this may be less than 30 minutes.